LEON POTGIETER

Junior Full-stack Software Developer



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Portfolio | Github | LinkedIn

Summary

- I have a **master's degree** in the domain of social science and a diploma in Full Stack Software Development.
- I have extensive experience as a **team manager**, public speaker and visionary leader in cross-cultural contexts.
- I am looking to make a **career change** after 20+ years in the faith-based non-profit sector.
- I have a great passion for software development, especially **back-end work**, and I enjoy learning new technologies.
- This project best showcases **my current abilities** and technical skills: https://heritage-company.net/

Technical Skillset

Languages:	Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS.
Frameworks:	Django, Flask, Bootstrap
Version Control:	GitHub, Git
Deployment:	Linux, Docker, and Heroku
Databases:	PostgreSQL
Libraries:	jQuery, Stripe
Additional:	Agile, UX Design, E-commerce, Affiliate Marketing, SEO

Education

Jan 2024 - Present	Code Institute Diploma in Full-stack Software Development *Accredited by the University West of Scotland*	Dublin, Ireland (Remote)
2013 – 2016	South African Theological Seminary Master's Degree in Integrative Theology *Graduated Cum Laude*	Johannesburg, South Africa

Jan. 2011 – Dec. 2012	South African Theological Seminary Honour's Degree in Theology *Graduated Cum Laude*	Johannesburg, South Africa
2005 - 2008	Auckland Park Theological Seminary Bachelor's degree in theology *Graduated Cum Laude*	Johannesburg, South Africa
1990 - 2002	Hexvalley High School High School *Graduated top of class*	De Doorns, South Africa

Portfolio Projects

- **Heritage Company -** A full-fledged e-commerce platform selling luxury watches from the well-known Swiss brands *Breitling*, *Tag Heuer*, *Omega* and *Tissot*. Customers can browse products and make purchases through a functioning checkout and payment system that includes email verification.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/code-institute-project-5
- **TaskFlow -** A free, customisable and distraction-free Kanban Web application that allows users to keep track of tasks related to a professional or personal project. The app has a minimalistic visual design with a built-in theme toggle and allows users to customise their Kanban boards, columns and tasks as needed. Account registration is needed.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/code-institute-project-4
- **VaultGuard -** A mock password manager, that allows users to store a list of usernames and passwords for a variety of services that they use. Each new user creates a personal account with a strong master password that is verified before they can then proceed to create a 'vault' (or list of username + password credentials) that they would like to save. Passwords are encrypted with a user master key.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/code-institute-project-3
- **TODO -** TODO is a simple, but multifunctional to-do web-based application that allows users to create a simple to-do list that is fully editable, sortable, and may be filtered according to task status. The app incorporates a visually appealing design that is minimalistic and has built-in light/dark functionality which the user can toggle. Optional sound effects and a help toggle are also available.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/code-institute-project-2
- **SmokeStack Society -** Smokestack Society is the business website of a (fictional) for-profit cooking class hosted in Linz, Austria. The site is designed with prospective customers in mind, convincing visitors to sign up for a cooking class. The entire site funnels visitors towards the sign-up page and the various layouts were designed, and content written, to motivate visitors to sign up.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/code-institute-project-1
- **Entertainment Web App Frontend -** A mock video streaming platform showcasing more advanced front-end design. Based on a challenge from frontendmentor.io.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/fm8-entertainment-web-app

- **Dictionary App -** Functioning dictionary web app with audio pronunciation, using the API from dictionaryapi.dev. Based on a challenge from frontendmentor.io.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/fm7-dictionary-app
- **Advice Generator -** Simple advice generator with minimalistic front end and API integration. Based on a challenge from frontendmentor.io.
  GitHub - https://github.com/leonp84/fm6-advice-generator-app
- **PluckAndPlayGuitar (Older Project) –** A now-archived project from 2009-2016 that I built using a WordPress-like system. This revenue-generating site made extensive use of SEO and online marketing strategies, generated decent income and was eventually sold to a buyer in 2016.
  Web Archive - https://web.archive.org/web/20160118120810/http://www.pluckandplayguitar.com/
- **Effective Public Speaking Tips (Older Project) –** Similar to PluckAndPlay above. Now archived but built around SEO principles and generated some income.
  Web Archive - https://web.archive.org/web/20131014014333/http://www.effective-public-speaking-tips.com/

Work Experience

April 2016 - Present **Pastor & Counsellor** **Freie Christengemeinde Linz** **Linz, Austria**

- Team Leader, project manager, counsellor and preacher responsible for visionary leadership on new projects. Role involved regular public speaking and leading of meetings.
- Maintained the church's online presence, local membership database and website.

June 2012 – August 2014 **Senior Pastor** **Dongshin Church** **Daegu, South Korea**

- Pastor and team leader responsible for visionary leadership and regular teaching, preaching and counselling in an expatriate church.

August 2010 – August 2012 **English Teacher** **Manchon School** **Daegu, South Korea**

- Teaching English classes to 20+ Korean students in a cross-cultural environment.
- Designing Educational material and basic digital linguistic games.

March 2009 – May 2010 **English Teacher** **Yesol English Academy** **Ulsan, South Korea**

- Full-time English teacher and private tutor for Korean children of Kindergarten and Elementary age.
- Designing of Educational Material in Digital and print format.

2007 – 2008 **Worship Pastor & Musician** **Witpoortjie AFM Church** **Johannesburg, ZAR**

- Employed as Musician and vocalist responsible for band leadership and planning of events together with church leadership.

2003-2005 **Installation Technician** **NTL Internet & Cable** **London, England**

- Installation of Broadband Internet, Cable TV and telephonic systems for residential clients of a large British Telecom Provider. Installation included both hardware and software setup for clients at home.

Non-Technical Skills & Achievements

- Management & Leadership: Experienced with small- to medium-scale project-related planning, management of teams, organisation and visionary leadership.
- Strong communicative skills: I am a trained and seasoned public speaker both on and off camera. Over the past 20 years, I have spoken live to tens of thousands of people on a variety of faith and non-faith-related topics.
- Cross-Cultural Experience: I have worked in South Africa, England, South Korea and Austria. I bring cross-cultural sensitivity to team settings.
- Graphic and Video Design: Experienced in computer-aided graphic design, desktop publishing and digital video recording and production.
- Musician & Vocalist: Trained as a musician with the ability to lead and play the acoustic/electric/bass guitar. An experienced and trained vocal musician with many years of live stage performance in church and other settings.

Additional Information/Interests

- Participated in Code Institute September 24 **Hackathon** 'Classical Music Month'. Planning, design, sprints, project management, deployment. Our team project: https://alvor1991.github.io/Hackathon-Team1/
- Currently learning **React.js**, Algorithms & Data Structures on Udemy.
- I attend **Coding Community meetups** with FaithTech in Linz.
- I have a passion for **Home Automation,** specifically the open-source Home Assistant software and community. I have built my own ESP32 sensors that I use for customised home automation.
- From 2009 – 2013 I built various **SEO-focused content websites** around personal interests that used (primarily) Google AdSense and affiliate marketing to generate revenue for myself. These were built using a WordPress-like system before I had much technical training in full-stack development. The 'Portfolio Projects' section lists two of these projects.
- Regular engagement on **Slack tech forums** and use of Google meetings.

Languages

English	Fluent
Afrikaans	Fluent
German	Intermediate Fluency

References

Pastor Martin Griesfelder – Senior Pastor at the Freie Christengemeinde Linz / Previous employer
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